

The `prompt` parameter provides high-level context to the agent, functioning as a system prompt that defines the agent's personality, expertise, and behavioral guidelines. It accepts a string value that should describe the agent's role, knowledge domain, and approach to tasks (e.g., "You are a senior React developer specializing in modern hooks and performance optimization").

This parameter significantly influences how the agent interprets requests and formulates responses, allowing you to create specialized agents for different roles like frontend developers, QA testers, or product managers, and works in conjunction with `resources` files to provide comprehensive context that shapes the agent's behavior throughout the conversation.

Objective

Learn how to use the `prompt` parameter to define agent personality and behavior.

Instructions

Step 1: Create Agent with Custom Prompt

```
1 cat > .kiro/agents/frontend-specialist.json << 'EOF'
2 {
3   "name": "frontend-specialist",
4   "description": "React frontend development expert",
5   "prompt": "You are a senior React developer with 8+ years of experience. You specialize in modern React patterns, hooks, performance optimization, and accessibility. Always provide detailed, actionable advice.",
6   "tools": ["read", "write"],
7   "allowedTools": ["read"]
8 }
9 EOF
```

Step 2: Create Agent with Different Prompt

```
1 cat > .kiro/agents/backend-specialist.json << 'EOF'
2 {
3   "name": "backend-specialist",
4   "description": "Backend API development expert",
5   "prompt": "You are an experienced backend developer specializing in RESTful APIs, database design, and microservices architecture. You have deep knowledge of Node.js, Express.js, and MongoDB.",
6   "tools": ["read", "write"],
7   "allowedTools": ["read"]
8 }
9 EOF
```

Step 3: Test Prompt Effectiveness

 Try using prompts from one agent configuration with another agent to observe the variations in their responses.

1. Test Frontend Specialist:

```
1 kiro-cli chat --agent frontend-specialist
```

Ask these questions:

"How should I structure a React component for a user profile card?"
"What's the best way to handle form state in React?"
"Review this code for React best practices"

2. Test Backend Specialist:

```
1 kiro-cli chat --agent backend-specialist
```

Ask these questions:

"Design a REST API for user management"
"How should I structure error handling in Express.js?"
"What's the best way to implement authentication middleware?"

Expected Response Differences:

- **frontend-specialist:** React-specific solutions, mentions hooks, component patterns, accessibility
- **backend-specialist:** API design focus, database considerations, security, scalability

Verification

-  Frontend agent focuses on React-specific solutions
-  Backend agent discusses API and architecture concerns
-  Responses reflect the expertise defined in prompts

Key Learnings

- `prompt` parameter defines agent personality and expertise
- Specific role definitions lead to more targeted responses
- System prompts significantly influence the quality and focus of advice
- Well-crafted prompts improve agent effectiveness